



The Fire Rises

A 77-minute long BTS documentary on the creation of Nolan's iconic The Dark Knight Trilogy. <http://digit.in/feb21-31>



10 Years With Hayao Miyazaki

Exclusive 4-part documentary chronicling the creative process of the legendary Japanese filmmaker and artist. <http://digit.in/feb21-31>

Ooh! Look, a Bandwagon!

Boo-Man isn't too happy about the sudden influx of "privacy experts"

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Ever wondered where the phrase "jump on the bandwagon" originated from? I did too, and found out that it was *ugh* political in nature. The Americans always find a way to ruin things with marketing, and this too was their doing. What happens when you seed political ambitions into a circus clown? You get Dan Rice, the now famous circus clown who used circus tricks and a 'bandwagon' to get people's attention in 1848. While today you could just generate sound using loudspeakers and play recorded music, back in Rice's day, music was played by a live band, and when you held a parade, the band had to move with the parade. This meant either a marching band, or one carried on a wagon pulled by horses. Of course if you're going to have a wagon, you might as well spruce it up to match everything else in a parade, and thus bandwagons were large and decorated. And if you're a clown looking to be seen and your political message to be heard, you'd shout it from the bandwagon. Dan Rice's ploy was so successful that other politicians wanted to be seen beside him, and they'd do this by literally "jumping on his bandwagon" as it moved past.

If you're wondering what the heck this useless information has to do

with Digit, and more specifically, my column, it's because jumping on bandwagons is just so common in life that it happens in our technology domain as well. All too often in fact.

The latest one that irks me to no extent is this whole uproar about WhatsApp and the changing of their privacy settings. Those using Business accounts should be irritated, because it is their chats that will be read by the servers at Facebook in order to extract information. However, everyone using a personal account also started jumping up and down, screaming bloody murder.

Internet uncles and aunties everywhere were talking about the new privacy changes by having long discussions in... wait for it... WhatsApp groups. "Let's all join Signal", some uncles shouted to the same family group that anyway ignores their daily forwards that border on racism and sexism. Some aunties were confused about the Signal and Telegram, and were being given gyaan about these apps by others who can't even spell encryption.

Weeks later, and everyone was still using WhatsApp, and had, in fact, already accepted the terms of service. Some enterprising uncle had set up a Signal group, had sent out invites and was even helping grannies install the new app, albeit amongst huge amounts of confusion. Questions such as "What phone do you have Auntie?" were met by total confusion, or with answers such as, "the new one which Roshan bought me last year". "No auntie, is it Apple or Android?" would elicit some more confused answers, and all of this because we don't want Facebook to see the same pictures forwarded in WhatsApp that are already uploaded on this

same uncle's Facebook profile, and also on his daughter's instagram account!

My old school friends' group had the same story. There was no explaining about installing apps needed, but the level of information being spread was not too much more informed. And all of this by people who would message me on Facebook Messenger to tell me the problems they are having in life and revealing far more personal information there than on the group chats on WhatsApp that are mainly just good old school and college canteen talk...

Yes, there are problems with Facebook and their products and the privacy we don't get from them, but these are hardly new. It's ridiculous for those who use Facebook and Instagram all day to worry about WhatsApp reading their location, or chats with business accounts. It's seriously silly to see some millennials, who check into a new place every 15 minutes and are posting photographs on 'insta' to show off every little boring facet of their lives, moan about "privacy".

And why am I ranting to you here about all of this? Because I cannot rant at my aunties and nephews on the WhatsApp family group, but I can do that here, in my 'safe space'.

For now though, I have to live with the fact that I now get three notifications for the same crappy forwarded message that my over-enthusiastic, retired uncle sends, because he started a Telegram group, a Signal group, and now sends everything to ALL three platforms! I'm seriously thinking of signing him up to a dating site so he will have something else to do instead of trying to run the family. Is there a Tinder for over 65s or something? Actually never mind, he might start inviting us there too! 🍷